

Matthew Dekenah

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Profile

A highly motivated, intelligent, and adaptable software engineering professional with over seventeen years of experience; predominantly in highly agile environments. I have diverse experience throughout the entire software development and test lifecycles. Apart from a highly analytical and hands-on approach to problem solving, I specialise in adapting the culture and processes of teams to improve culture, communication, collaboration, motivation, confidence in deployments, autonomy, and velocity.

I also have a proven track record in leadership and organisational skills, not only professionally, but through active involvement in community service, vocational and extra-curricular activities. Along with well-developed technical, analytical, and problem-solving skills, I am approachable, articulate, and attentive to the finer details, while remaining cognisant of wider constraints and opportunities.

Experience

Senior Engineering Manager | ClearScore | Cape Town, South Africa | 11/2024–Present

- Lead the ZA Marketplace engineering squad, owning delivery, technical direction, and people management.
- Set squad strategy and priorities in close partnership with Product, Design, and Commercial stakeholders.
- Build and sustain a high-performing, inclusive engineering culture with a focus on ownership, psychological safety, and continuous improvement.
- Develop engineers across levels and disciplines through coaching, performance management, and progression support.
- Improve delivery confidence, operational resilience, and quality through clearer ownership and pragmatic technical investment.
- **Technologies/tools:** *Scala, JSON, DataDog, Jenkins, Amplitude, DataBricks*

Senior Engineering Manager | D-One (ClearScore Group) | Edinburgh, UK | 05/2023–11/2024

- Lead role for Open Banking Services squad within the D-One business division.
- Prioritise work, own and implement strategy, and manage operations for the squad.
- Ensure squad and direct reports are enabled, supported and set up for success.
- Continue to be hands on and deliver work aligned to the squad and mission roadmap, objectives, and key results.
- Improve overall observability, reliability and resilience of squad-owned infrastructure and services.
- Increase reliability, velocity, and cohesion within the team while reducing knowledge silos.
- **Technologies/tools:** *C#.NET, TypeScript, Playwright, MySQL, AWS, Terraform, DataDog*

Senior Test Engineer | D-One (ClearScore Group) | Edinburgh, UK | 08/2022–05/2023

- As the first and only test specialist within ClearScore's DataOne (D-One) business division, construct and implement an organisation-wide test and quality strategy.
- Design and build end-to-end test frameworks for mission-critical systems and improve monitoring of key services.
- Contribute to test discipline strategy and best practice across the business.

Lead Test Engineer | IAM Cloud | Remote, UK | 06/2021–08/2022

- Architect IAM Cloud's test ecosystem, incorporating strategy, environment, and architecture.
- Develop and grow the testing function, including the hiring, line management and mentorship of additional test engineers.
- Build and develop custom CI automated test frameworks to exercise critical paths.
- Build up testing protocols for the APIs and ensure mitigations are in place for breaking changes.
- Mentor and guide others in testing approaches and techniques, to foster cross-business quality collaboration.
- Attend and contribute to architecture and pre-planning discussions to probe and understand risk profiles of upcoming work and projects.

Technologies/tools: *Python, PytestBDD, C#, C++, React.JS, Microsoft Graph, Azure DevOps, Postman, Playwright*

Selected achievements:

- Designed, presented and implemented an organisation-wide test and quality strategy and approach.
- Delivered a comprehensive conflict resolution test framework for a cloud filesystem sync service.
- Built and implemented an end-to-end system test framework with desktop and cloud system integrations.

Staff Test Engineer | FreeAgent | Edinburgh, UK | 04/2020–06/2021

Senior Test Engineer | FreeAgent | Edinburgh, UK | 06/2016–04/2020

- As FreeAgent's first dedicated test engineer, create, develop, and implement a comprehensive and embedded test strategy within the engineering organisation and build up the test engineering function from scratch.
- Work closely with engineers, designers, and product managers to help ensure that we deliver the right features to our customers to help them remain compliant with legislation and maintain the integrity of their accounts.
- Enhance existing test processes and procedures through iterative implementation with impact reviews to measure success and create a culture of quality software development.
- Coach and mentor engineers, analysts and product managers in confidence-enhancing test practices and approaches.
- Build tools to automate and facilitate testing initiatives.
- Evangelise test strategy, processes, and tools within and without the business through talks, blog posts and networking.
- Launch a testing forum to share knowledge and facilitate quality-enhancing discussions and actions and mentorship of more junior testers, analysts, and engineers.
- **Technologies/tools:** *Ruby on Rails, MySQL, AWS, Gherkin/Cucumber, JavaScript, XHTML, iXBRL, XML, HTML, CSS, Postman, Capybara*

Selected achievements:

- Creation of an active testing community, including mentorship and knowledge sharing practices with others.
- Successful design, rollout, and advocacy of engineering organisation test strategy.
- Overhaul and redesign of full application testing process, including API, mobile and third-party integrations testing.
- Expedited development and release of annual tax legislation updates through confidence-improving test approaches.
- Built a Slack and HR system integration to facilitate planning by highlighting leave and absences to teams.

Test Engineer | Skyscanner | Edinburgh, UK | 01/2014–06/2016

- Own and implement test strategy across revenue, reporting, and data platform teams.
- Design, build and maintain a comprehensive, automated end-to-end regression suite for user-event and revenue data logging across platforms, including mobile, and implement it in relevant continuous integration pipelines.
- Create an interactive test harness for a RESTful service API and actively test the service during early development.
- Develop an automated stream processing job to enhance data integrity by performing technical validation on logged data.
- Evangelise and advocate for data quality throughout the business in tooling, technique, and process.
- Perform detailed investigations into issues highlighted by monitoring and automation anomalies, and those exposed through exploratory exercises.
- Generate solutions to promote the adoption of a unified data platform across the business with shared taxonomies.
- Collaborate with other squads across the business in enhancing monitoring and mean-time-to-detection rates for high risk and priority production operations.
- **Technologies/tools:** *Python, XML, TeamCity, Selenium, JavaScript, SauceLabs, RabbitMQ, SQL Server, Elasticsearch, C#.NET, CoffeeScript, CSS, TestRail, Google Protocol Buffers, AWS, Apache Samza, Apache Kafka, Linux, Docker*

Selected achievements:

- Oversaw massive improvements in data integrity.
- Vastly improved mean-time-to-detection for high impact data-logging issues (from days or hours to minutes).
- Significant improvements in revenue estimation allowing for better operational strategy decisions.

Test Analyst | NHS Lothian | Edinburgh, UK | 11/2012–01/2014

- Develop test scripts and strategies for the vital acute and community patient management system.
- Lead automation process for regression test harnesses.
- Ensure consistent performance and functionality of the system across environments.
- Investigate and analyse identified issues and own escalation of priority tasks.
- Become systems expert in mission-critical functional areas to enhance release processes.
- Support and lead knowledge management and sharing processes within team.
- **Technologies/tools:** *Ruby, Python, Selenium, Watir Webdriver*

Selected achievements:

- Expedited release of features to improve clinician and patient experience through coordinated automation strategy.
- Timeous and smooth release of features as part of new Mental Health Act compliance.

QA Test Engineer | Sumdog (Crocodile Clips) | Edinburgh, UK | 10/2011–11/2012

- Design, write, execute, and own comprehensive test plans defined in an Agile Scrum environment.
- Coordinate with product owners and developers to deliver priority updates for high-load web application.
- Coordinate UI testing across environments, including cross-browser testing on Windows, Mac OS X and Linux.
- Prioritise and triage support issues.
- **Technologies/tools:** *AWS, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL*

Selected achievements:

- Quick turnaround on defects affecting US-wide school mathematics contests.
- Enhanced cross-browser/platform testing strategy.

Senior Quality Assurance Analyst | StatPro | Cape Town, South Africa | 11/2010–08/2011

- As test lead, create a culture that enables own team to flourish and develop to its full potential.
- Take responsibility for management, merges, queries, and maintenance of sensitive client databases.
- Take ownership, implement, manage, and follow correct escalation path of resources and issues.
- Provide estimations and resource time-costs, managing resources flexibly to meet changing priorities in Agile environment.
- Develop protocols reflecting own personal expertise and share these with others.
- Make a positive contribution to improving efficiency and quality of the team through key priorities.
- Work with key players to create comprehensive test strategies for new functional areas.
- Provide team overview and communication channel to Development Manager and Director.
- Continue to deliver on existing QA roles and functions.

Selected achievements:

- Significantly enhanced testing team performance by removing key-man dependencies through active mentoring and knowledge sharing activities.
- Successfully enhanced team and development processes to deliver support fixes more effectively and efficiently.

Quality Assurance Analyst | StatPro | Cape Town, South Africa | 06/2009–11/2010

- Ensure developed solutions meet functional requirements with comprehensively built test plans.
- Create and maintain an automated regression test strategy and framework.
- Participate in story development and specification.
- Undertake performance, load, exploratory and localisation testing.
- Manage databases on Microsoft SQL Server and build comprehensive queries to ensure data integrity.
- Provide critical frontline support to international internal clients.
- Be a key player in authorising application releases.
- Track bugs and own their resolution by coordinating with developers and stakeholders.
- **Technologies/tools:** *Ranorex, SQL Server, VMWare*

Selected achievements:

- Ensured company and products retained Microsoft Gold Partner status by coordinating efforts for seamless verification.
- Provided significant input into the release of several major product versions and the release of a new analytics platform.

Developer | CellSmart Technologies | Cape Town, South Africa | 03/2009–06/2009

- Implement web site creation, design, and maintenance.
- Design and develop a proprietary mobile web platform.
- Analyse and troubleshoot existing mobile technology systems.
- **Technologies:** *PHP, MySQL, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, XHTML, CodeIgniter MVC framework*

Certification

- **2019** Black Box Software Testing Bug Advocacy Course | *Association for Software Testing (Class 200-AA)*
- **2018** Black Box Software Testing Test Design Course | *Association for Software Testing (Class 300-O)*
- **2015** Black Box Software Testing Foundations Course | *Association for Software Testing (Class 101-AG)*
- **2013** Certified Tester Foundation Level | *BCS/ISEB/ISTQB (License 990453184)*
- **2010** CompTIA Network+ | *CompTIA (License LPR729LJGV15TXG)*
- **2008** Knowledge Management Tools and Applications | *University of the Western Cape, NSS Programme*

Education

MSc Global Health and Public Policy

The University of Edinburgh, 2011–2012

- Holder of the **Rotary Ambassadorial Scholarship**.

BA Honours (Socio-Informatics) cum laude / 1st Class

The University of Stellenbosch, 2008

- Honours coursework: *Database systems, design, and development; information security; information systems theory and analysis; information law, policy and ethics; project management; decision-making theory; strategy; leadership; visual modelling; knowledge economy and management; ontologies; intelligent systems; internet technology; PHP; networking.*
- Recipient of the **Sasol/Golden Key International Honour Society Excellence Award** in the ICT Category.
- Holder of two **Stellenbosch University Merit Scholarships** and the **Babette Taute Scholarship**.
- Graduated at the **top of the class**.

Senior Certificate with Distinction

Diocesan College, 1999–2003

- Six distinctions in *Computer Science, Mathematics, Science, English, Afrikaans, and Geography*.

Languages

Native/Fluent English, Afrikaans

Intermediate French, German

Advanced Brazilian Portuguese, Spanish

Beginner Italian, Welsh, Russian

Interests

Activism and advocacy, cooking and gastronomy, history, languages, music, personal finance, policy, politics, public health, reading, running, social media, technology, tennis, and travel.

Further Details

For details on extracurricular, vocational, and voluntary positions and activities, please see LinkedIn. Selected recommendations are viewable there, and further references are available upon request.